

PO Box Rental API — one open question

To	Emirates Post PO Box API team
From	7X — NXN conversational assistant
Environment	<code>https://box-stg.emiratespost.ae/services/pobox</code> (staging)
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The rental flow works end to end against staging — availability, hold, order creation. One design question remains, and there are a few behaviours we found only by trial that we would like confirmed.

Everything below is from live calls on staging, with the customer's own UAE PASS session token as the bearer.

The sequence works

For completeness, since we raised `157 ERROR_GETTING_HOLD_DETAILS` with you earlier: that was ours, not yours. Every occurrence traced back to something wrong on our side — an invented reference, a hold belonging to a different box, and an incomplete `billingDetail`. With a correct payload the sequence is reliable:

```
POST /api/v1/Rental/Select { "bundleId": "IN", "uniqueBoxID": "2450063",
                             "poBoxExpiryDate": "2027-08-29T00:00:00+00:00" }
200 OK  subscriptionReferenceNumber: 260611703, minimumAmount: 370.0

POST /api/v1/Rental/Save    { "subscriptionReferenceNumber": "260611703",
                             "totalAmount": 370, "userProfile": {...},
                             "paymentProperties": { "billingDetail": {...all six fields...} }
}
200 OK  orderNo: 260961740
```

No changes needed from you for this. It is recorded here only because we asked about it before we understood it.

The open question: `Save` opens its own payment

On success, `Save` returns a hosted payment page and an N-Genius order on **your** outlet:

```
200 OK
{ "payload": {
  "orderNo": "260961739",
  "custProfID": "6542907",
```

```
"paymentGateWayResponse": {
  "paymentUrl": "https://paypage.sandbox.ngenius-payments.com/v2?code=...",
  "referenceNumber": "4d1e9cc3-670c-45ca-9084-6496100afdf0",
  "niOrderResult": { "outletId": "b78ef8c7-ce2a-41d6-84c9-e6219557a991", "...": "..." }
}
} }
```

We take payment on **our own** N-Genius outlet, so yours is never settled:

```
POST /api/v1/Rental/UpdatePayment/4d1e9cc3-670c-45ca-9084-6496100afdf0
200 OK
{ "payload": { "orderNumber": "260961735",
               "isPaymentSuccess": false,
               "paymentDetails": { "amountPaid": 0.0 } } }
```

The N-Genius order stays at state `STARTED` , and **the box does not appear in the customer's portal** even though the rental record exists.

What we'd like to know

1. Is there a way to record a rental as **already paid** — a flag, a different endpoint, or a payment reference we can pass in?
2. If not, is the intended flow for the customer to pay on the `paymentUrl` you return, and for us to poll `UpdatePayment/{referenceNumber}` until `isPaymentSuccess` is `true` ?
3. Roughly how long after payment does `isPaymentSuccess` flip? We need to know how long to wait before telling a customer anything.

Three things we found by trial — please confirm they're intended

#	Finding	Why it matters
1	Select needs uniqueBoxId from FreeBoxes (e.g. 2450364), not boxId (450364). Sending boxId returns 108 BOX_NOT_FREE.	BOX_NOT_FREE reads as "someone else took it". We were telling customers boxes were unavailable when they were free and we'd sent the wrong identifier.
2	paymentProperties.billingDetail is optional in the spec but required in practice , and all six fields are needed. Omitting the block returns 400 {"Error":"Error from payment gateway"}; sending it with only firstName, lastName, emailAddress returns 400 ... 157 ERROR_GETTING_HOLD_DETAILS.	Neither error names the missing field, and the second one points at the hold, which is not the problem. This cost us most of a day.
3	UpdatePayment takes paymentGateWayResponse.referenceNumber . Passing niOrderResult.reference — also a UUID, in the same response — returns 500 Internal system error.	Two UUIDs side by side with nothing to distinguish them.

Other observations

- **Rental/Save takes ~17 seconds** (measured: 16.95s). Select returns in under a second. Is that expected? We've raised our client timeout to 60s.
- **Rental/Bundle** takes request=P (personal) / request=C (corporate), not EmirateCode. With EmirateCode it returns 400.
- **FreeBoxes needs a customer session** — 401 with the API key alone.
- **LocationId must be the branch's own officeId**, not mainOfficeId. Naif is officeId 214 / mainOfficeId 209; 209 returns an empty list rather than an error, which reads as "no boxes available".
- **Availability varies sharply by branch** (Dubai, bundle IN, 30 Aug): Dubai Central 201 → 0 · Naif 214 → 5 · Al Badaa 233 → 81 · Umm Suqeim 241 → 38 · Al Barsha 244 → 318 · Al Warqa 283 → 9

Reservations we've left stranded

Testing created holds and orders that were never completed. If they don't expire on their own, could they be released?

Box	Branch	State
378781, 378785, 378790	Naif (214)	held, no order
449691, 449949, 449989, 450000	Al Barsha (244)	held, no order
450152	Al Barsha (244)	order 260961736 , unpaid
449922, 449997	Al Barsha (244)	orders 260961732 , 260961735 , unpaid
450364	Al Barsha (244)	order 260961739 , unpaid

The call sequence we're using

Rental/Bundle	request=P	
Rental/BoxLocations	BundleId=IN, EmirateCode=DXB	→ officeId per branch
Rental/FreeBoxes	BundleId=IN, LocationId=<officeId>	→ { uniqueBoxId, boxId }
Rental/ExpiryDates	BundleId=IN	→ exact date strings
Rental/Select	bundleId, uniqueBoxID, poBoxExpiryDate	→ subscriptionReferenceNumber
Rental/Save	subscriptionReferenceNumber, totalAmount, userProfile, paymentProperties.billingDetail	

poBoxExpiryDate is copied verbatim from ExpiryDates , offset included (2027-08-29T00:00:00+00:00).
Recomputing it or dropping the offset returns 400 "Invalid date value."

Happy to jump on a call and walk through it live.